Colson Montgomery

Bats left · 2026 · 633 PA · xChase+ 68, 257th of 261

Swings at 33% of pitches outside the zone. Hitters on average swing at 29% of the same pitches.

RUNS AT STAKE

3.1

per 600 PA, on far-off pitches

What to work on

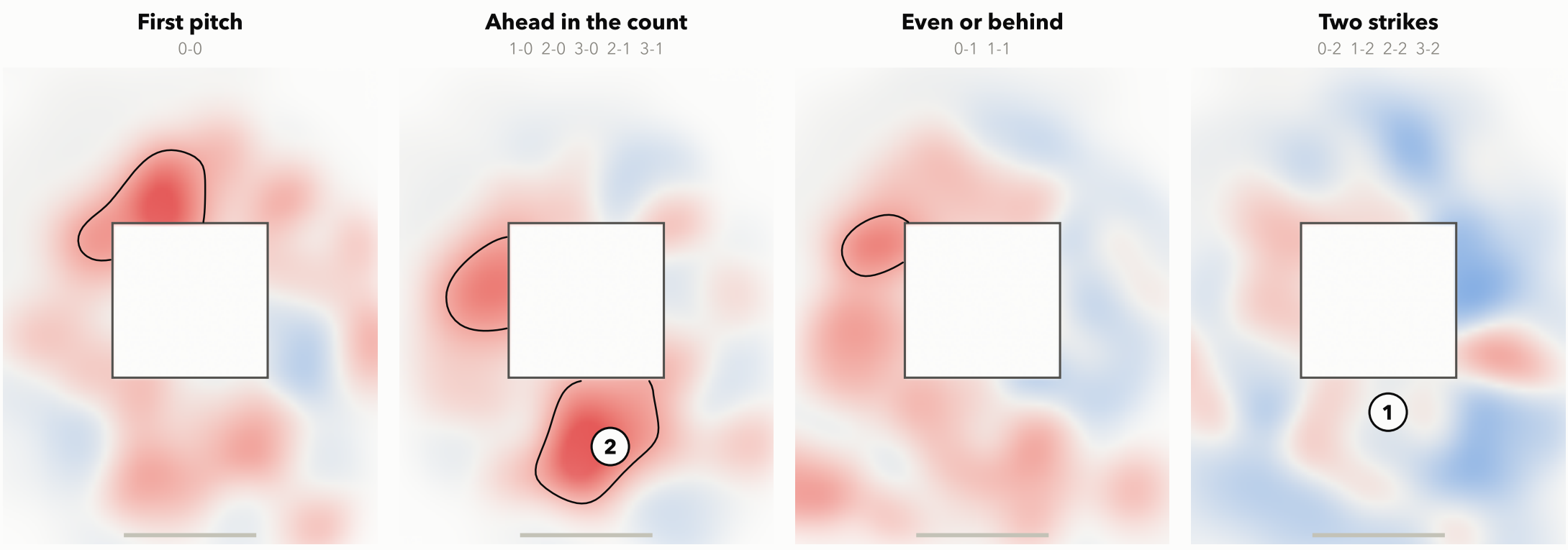
- With two strikes against right-handers, let breaking balls below the zone go. You swung at about as many of them as an average hitter would, but those swings cost you 1.9 runs per 600 PA. The ones you swung at were typically 4 inches off the zone.
- When you're ahead against right-handers, let breaking balls below the zone go. You swung at 57% of them; hitters on average swing at 25%. The ones you swung at were typically 9 inches off the zone.
- Your bigger issue is contact: you miss on 68% of your chases, against 45% for other hitters on the same pitches, so take a stricter line with two strikes.

TARGET

In the spots above you chased 4 points above the league in 2026. Those spots get better on their own, so with no change at all you'd be at about -1 in 2027. Below that is a fix.

Where you chase, all pitchers

red: more than the average hitter at that spot and count; blue: less



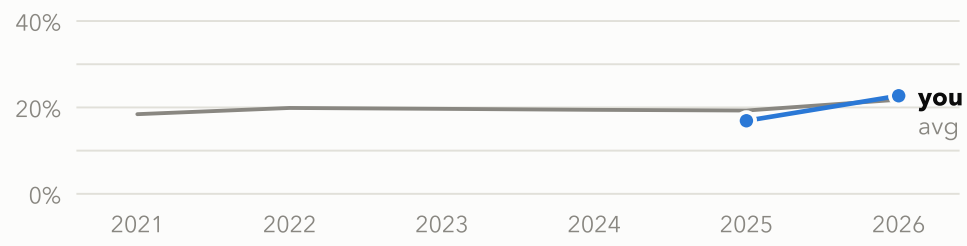
Biggest leaks

numbered on the pictures · runs per 600 PA

1	Two strikes, breaking balls below the zone	58% vs 54%	**−1.9**
2	Ahead in the count, breaking balls below the zone	57% vs 25%	**−1.3**

You vs the average hitter on the same pitches; the runs are what the swing choices cost.

Far-off chase rate by season



Pitches at least 4 inches off the plate: you against every hitter.

Chases vs the average hitter, same spot and count

−30 pts league +30 pts

Blue: you take more. Red: you chase more.

Faded: too few pitches to say. Outline: 15 points or more.

Does fixing a leak pay? Hitters who cut leak chasing 10 points more than predicted gained 1.4 to 2.0 runs per 600 PA (xwOBA) and 4.3 to 4.7 xChase+ points, for 0.3 to 0.5 pts fewer swings at strikes, whatever their count check. Season to season it was mostly runs not lost: chasing more cost 2.9 runs, cutting more gained 0.3.

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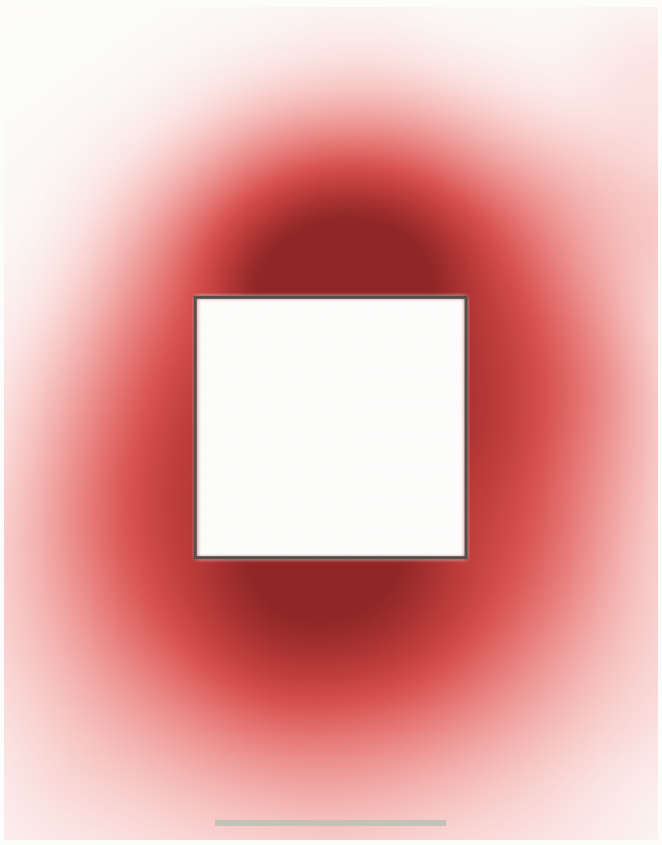
per 600 PA, on far-off pitches

How to read your card

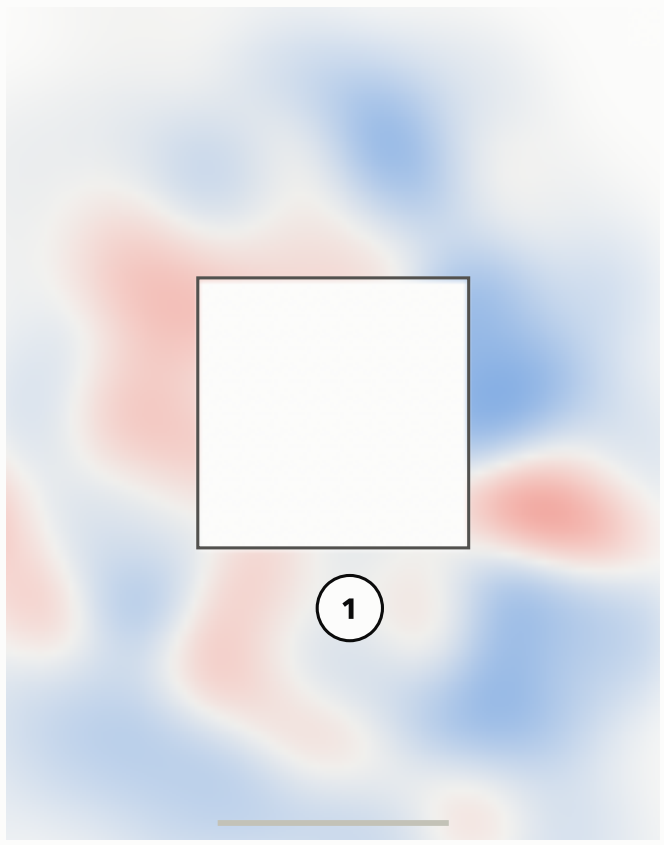
1. Red is where you swing at balls more than other hitters do at the same spot and in the same count. Blue is where you take more than they do. Gray is about average, and faded color means you haven't seen enough pitches there to say.
2. The box is your strike zone, seen from the catcher. The line under it is home plate. Everyone chases more with two strikes, so the comparison is always with hitters in the same count. Nobody is judged for a two-strike swing everyone makes.
3. The numbers on the pictures are your biggest leaks: the pitches where your swing choices cost the most runs over a full season.
4. The plan is one pitch per line. It is the pitch that is clearly a ball, never the borderline one; each line says how far off the plate the ones you swung at were. Taking the clearly-off pitch is what counts. Keep swinging at strikes. When no single pitch explains what your choices cost, the first line says so and names the count to start in.
5. The target: everyone's worst spots look better the next season by themselves, with no work at all. The second number is where you would land if you changed nothing. Beating it is the fix. Matching it is not.
6. Runs at stake is what your choices on far-off pitches cost over 600 plate appearances, compared with an average hitter. Hitters who cut their leak chasing mostly stopped losing runs; the walks come first, the hits come later if they come.

What normal looks like, with two strikes

The average hitter: how often they swing



You: more (red) or less (blue) than that



Average hitter's chase rate

0% 70%+

You vs the average hitter

−30 pts league +30 pts

The average hitter chases most with two strikes, below and away. Your card only shows where you differ from that.